Whitney Kotlewski, PhD

VP of Product Experiences | Strategy & Portfolio Leadership | AI, Data & Spatial Platforms
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SUMMARY

Product executive with 17+ years leading strategy, vision, AI roadmaps, and execution across data and spatial platforms. Directs cross-functional teams, guides organizations through change, and partners with executive leadership to set priorities and deliver business results across enterprise software and mission-critical operations.

SKILLS

Product strategy, Portfolio management, Roadmap prioritization, AI strategy, Customer discovery, Go-to-market, Sales enablement, Opportunity sizing, Developer platforms, APIs and SDKs, MCP, Enterprise capabilities, Organizational leadership, Hiring and budgeting, AI/ML, Data platforms, Design systems

EXPERIENCE

Vice President of Product
Slingshot Aerospace | Windsor, CO
04/2026 – Present

- Delivered Slingshot Portal's reusable platform in 2 months; grew users 3x in 4 months.
- Own vision and roadmaps for space operations intelligence and autonomy, articulating AI strategy, APIs, MCP, and enterprise capabilities.
- Established a biweekly release cadence, enabling consistent delivery and deeper measurement of adoption, usage, and customer feedback to validate product decisions and inform roadmap priorities.
- Report to the CTO; scaled the product organization ~6x across product management, strategy, design, research, customer experience, and space data in the U.S. and U.K.
- Partner with GTM and leadership on sales, demonstrations, and strategic opportunities during a tenure encompassing ~$124M in company capital raised and $96M+ in U.S. Space Force awards, including $27M for AI training and a $69.2M Phase III contract.
- Built Product Superbase, an AI-enabled knowledge base of 25K+ source files spanning research, sales, market, and usage data, connecting decisions and delivery evidence to team workflows; improved roadmap alignment.
- Established shared product and marketing design systems with ~240 tokens and 1,200+ mission-operations components to support reuse across platform experiences.

Senior Director of Product
Slingshot Aerospace | Windsor, CO
2025 – 04/2026

Head of Product Design & Research
Slingshot Aerospace | Windsor, CO
04/2024 – 2025

Director, Product Design - Platform & Services
Matterport
04/2021 – 10/2023

- Led design across eight platform experiences spanning web, marketplace, eCommerce, cloud, enterprise, and developer APIs and SDKs following a ~$2.9B public listing.
- Company revenue grew from ~$111M to ~$158M and subscribers nearly doubled (~1.9x) by FY2023.
- Scaled design 8x and helped expand the broader organization ~3x; led hiring, organizational planning, budgeting, and strategic planning.

- Integrated AI/ML into 3D digital twins; advanced research, accessibility, and design systems; partnered with Marketing on customer journeys, positioning, and launches.

Head of UX Innovation & Special Programs
Esri
12/2019 – 04/2021

- Led enterprise product and UX innovation across analytics, drone mapping, mobile navigation, 2D/3D GIS, and developer APIs and SDKs, including applied machine learning, as company revenue grew from ~$1.1B to $1.3B+.
- Led a five-person design team.

Design Lead & Senior UX Architect
Esri
10/2014 – 12/2019

Co-Founder & Director
Black Girls MAPP (concurrent with Esri)
02/2019 – 05/2021

- Co-founded a 150+ person civic technology initiative delivering 24 maps, 24 data layers, 59 apps, and 10 civic products; recognized with the 2021 AAG Diversity & Inclusion Award.

Executive Design Advisor / Advisory Board Member
Sonara
07/2022 – 10/2023

- Advised the CEO and CIO on experience strategy and operational improvements, helping grow subscription purchases ~80x. Acquired by BOLD in 2024.

Adjunct Professor
Claremont Graduate University
08/2024 – Present

- Created Design for Good, the university's first-ever novel incubator program and course.

Customer Experience Lead & Research Consultant
Pacific Life
02/2014 – 10/2014

UX Design Lead, Instructor & Researcher
IUPUI
07/2010 – 07/2013

Media, Web & Print Designer
Various Companies
04/2009 – 07/2013

EDUCATION

PhD, Information Systems & Technology
Claremont Graduate University
2024

- AI and data visualization dissertation; patent pending.

MS, Informatics
Indiana University-Purdue University Indianapolis
2013

MS, Human-Computer Interaction
Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute
2010

BS, Electronic Media, Arts and Communications
Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute
2010